

## Major suit raises

This set of practice deals is about very basic bidding using only Major suit bids. The Major suits are Hearts and Spades.

The purpose of these deals is to provide practice in deciding whether to stop at a part score, bid game or bid slam. The important point is figuring out how many combined points the partnership has.

Keep in mind:

you need 26 points to make game (4♥ 4♠)

you need 33 points to make slam (6♥ 6♠)

open 1♥ or 1♠ with 13-21 points at least five of the suit

respond by raising to 2-level with 6-10 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 3-level with 11-12 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 13-16 points and at least three of the suit

respond by raising to 4-level with 8-12 points and at least five of the suit

Board: 1

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 3♥

Declarer: North

Lead: ♦Q

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♠4

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: South

Lead: ♣J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♦Q

**Board 1**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 10 9 7 5

♥ 9 6

♦ 10 7

♣ A 8 4 3

♠ 8 6 3

♥ A K Q 7 2

♦ K 6

♣ 10 9 5



♠ A 4 2

♥ 10 3

♦ Q J 5 4 2

♣ K 6 2

♠ Q J

♥ J 8 5 4

♦ A 9 8 3

♣ Q J 7

SOUTH has 11 points and she should pass.

NORTH has a minimum 1♥ opening, 13 points and five trumps.

SOUTH, with 4-card trump support, jumps to 3♥.  
(This is called a Limit Raise.)

A Limit Raise is an invitational bid, but NORTH can add and he knows the total points will be either 24 or 25. So he passes 3♥.

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1♥

Pass

3♥

All Pass

3♥ by North

Lead: ♦ Q

**Board 2**

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ J 9 6 2  
♥ K Q 7 5  
♦ 8 3  
♣ 10 7 4

♠ A 8 5

♥ J 9 8

♦ A K 6 2

♣ J 8 3



♠ K Q 10 7 3

♥ A 4 2

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A 6

♠ 4

♥ 10 6 3

♦ Q J 10 4

♣ K Q 9 5 2

EAST has a normal 1♠ opening bid, 14 points and five trumps.

WEST has good 4-card support and 7 points, so she raises to 2♠.

EAST passes, knowing he is not missing a game contract. WEST can have a maximum of 10 points, which would only reach 24 points when added to his 14.

*West**North**East**South*

1♠

Pass

2♠

All Pass

2♠ by East

Lead: ♠4

**Board 3**

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 9 8  
♥ A 7 3 2  
♦ Q J 4  
♣ J 10 7 3

♠ K 6 4 2

♥ J 8 5

♦ K 3 2

♣ A 6 2



♠ J 10  
♥ 10 9 6 4  
♦ 10 9 5  
♣ K Q 8 5

♠ A Q 7 5 3

♥ K Q

♦ A 8 7 6

♣ 9 4

With a 5-card ♠ suit and 16 points SOUTH should open 1 ♠.

NORTH has 11 points and four ♠s. So even though he has a balanced hand, he jumps to 3 ♠, a Limit Raise.

SOUTH adds: her 16 plus NORTH's 11/12 equals a game, 4 ♠.

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              |              |             | 1 ♠          |
| Pass         | 3 ♠          | Pass        | 4 ♠          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 4 ♠ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♣J     |              |             |              |

**Board 4**

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ J 10 8 6 4

♥ A 6

♦ A K 6

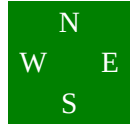
♣ K J 3

♠ 9 2

♥ Q 2

♦ Q J 10 9 4 3

♣ 7 4 2



♠ A K Q 7

♥ 7 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ Q 9 5

♠ 5 3

♥ K J 10 9 8 5

♦ 7

♣ A 10 8 6

WEST has the type of 5-card Major hand that many players would open 1NT. He has 17 points with most of them OUTSIDE the Major suit. But, many others would disagree so for this Deal WEST will open 1♠.

EAST has 11 points and excellent (is that strong enough?) ♠ support. So she naturally makes a Limit Raise of 3♠.

WEST adds the points and ignores the fact that his ♠ suit is Jack high. He bids 4♠.

*West*

1♠

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by West

Lead: ♦Q

*North*

Pass

*East*

3♠

*South*

Pass